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Replaces:
N/A

WaTech
Washington Technology Solutions

TELEPHONY
ENTERPRISE SERVICE STANDARD

See Also:
RCW 43.105.006 WaTech Purpose
RCW 43.105.020 Definitions
RCW 43.105.054 WaTech Governance
RCW 43.105.450 State agency information technology security

1. PURPOSE

This standard establishes Telephony, as an enterprise service under EA-02 – Establishing an Enterprise Service Policy.

A Washington state agency must not adopt, build, expand, or renew a service with similar capabilities unless it has an approved waiver or exemption (see Section 5).

2. SCOPE

IN SCOPE

- Voice, contact center, and 24x7 life-safety public branch exchange (PBX) communications.

OUT OF SCOPE

- Mobile Telephony, Radio Communications
- Emergency operations centers that require satellite phone connections
- Machine-to-machine applications or Supervisory Control and Data Acquisition (SCADA) applications

3. APPLICABILITY

This standard applies to all state agencies (as defined in RCW 43.105.020) and their organizational users.

This standard does not apply to the K-20 network, institutions of higher education, legislature, judiciary, or local governments.

4. ENTERPRISE SERVICE CAPABILITIES

The Telephony enterprise service designation encompasses the following capabilities:

1. Cloud-based phone systems that enable users to make and receive calls directly from Microsoft Teams.
2. Cloud-based contact centers equipped with a range of features designed to optimize contact center operations.
3. Life-Safety PBX to support 24/7 facilities (e.g., hospitals, correctional institutions, emergency response) that require onsite telephony equipment for survivable communications to support life and safety.

5. WAIVERS AND EXEMPTIONS TO THIS STANDARD

In accordance with POL-01-02-S Technology Policy and Standard Waiver Request Standard, agencies may qualify for a waiver or exemption from compliance with this standard. Agencies may request an exemption for situations that meet one of the following criteria.

1. **Exemptions may be approved in cases where telephony is being provided for:**
    a. Incarcerated individuals (such as JPay);
    b. Sites that cannot rely solely on cloud-based calling because they require phones to work during network outages (e.g., Washington State Patrol sites that dispatch officers and receive calls from 911 Public Safety Answering Point operators).

6. AUTHORITY

This standard is issued under the authority of RCW 43.105.054, which grants WaTech authority to establish statewide technology standards and enterprise services. RCW 43.105.006 establishes WaTech as the centralized provider of broadly used and uniform technology services. RCW 43.105.450 requires state agencies to comply with statewide information technology security policies and standards.

REFERENCES

1. Service Catalog Page: Telephony Services
2. Definition of Terms Used in WaTech Policies and Reports
3. RCW 43.105.006 WaTech Purpose
4. RCW 43.105.054 WaTech Governance
5. RCW 43.105.450 State agency information technology security

CONTACT INFORMATION

For questions about this policy, please email the WaTech Policy Mailbox.

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